

Where a traffic controller is to control traffic within 100 m of a signalised intersection with traffic signals operating in normal mode (not flashing amber or switched off), the traffic controller station must be positioned a safe distance from the operating traffic signals. Generally, a safe distance would be within the range of 50 to 100 m, but in exceptional circumstances, it may be safe at less than 50 m subject to a site-specific risk assessment. A risk assessment should be undertaken when a traffic controller is in view of traffic signals to ensure there is no conflict between the traffic controller's directions and the traffic signals.

2.8.2 Risk management

Risk management entails the identification and analysis of all safety risks likely to arise during works on road including the setup, operating, changing and ultimate dismantling of a traffic guidance scheme, followed by the determination of appropriate measures to mitigate those risks. Every person on site is responsible for the management of risk and cannot assume this is the responsibility of others. Any assessment of risk must be documented and include:

- description of the risk
- probability/likelihood of the risk occurring
- the consequences of the risk
- the treatment to be used to avoid/prevent the consequences
- how the control of the selected treatment, and its effectiveness, will be monitored.

2.8.3 Always be alert to changing conditions

When working on a site, it is important to:

- remember to watch for the angle of the sun which may shade the traffic control station and make the traffic controller hard to see, make signs difficult to read or blind or dazzle road users
- look for signs which may be set up in poor positions, blown over, vandalised, or too old or dirty
- be alert to peak hour traffic which may mean longer queues, or changes in road use mix (i.e. heavy vehicles, pedestrians etc.)
- be alert to any near misses as these may indicate a problem or emerging problem
- let the immediate supervisor know if a traffic controller suspects any problems as soon as possible, in a safe manner that does not compromise the safety of the traffic controller or others on site.

2.9 Traffic Control Station Operation

2.9.1 General

Traffic controllers are responsible for ensuring that traffic control stations are operated in a safe and orderly manner. The traffic control station must be operated in accordance with the guidelines specified in this Guide.

2.9.2 Queue monitoring

Queueing and delay is expected at stop locations where traffic controllers are positioned. Consider the speed of traffic and sight distance to the end of the queue and whether additional warnings are required to avoid end of queue collisions. The designer should provide appropriate layout for additional signs in these circumstances.

Surges in traffic demand can occur on a daily basis so adequate monitoring of traffic queues on site and active adjustment to sign positioning can mitigate risks in real time.